Story 1: Brian's Magical Skill (TA)

Brian liked to perform for people. His teacher said that she was going to choose someone to be in a school show that would be in the spring. Brian wanted to be chosen. He sang a song for his teacher. It was not very good. His teacher did not choose him.

Brian decided to put on a magic act. He bought some fancy magic cards and a hat. He tried to do some tricks on a table. The tricks were difficult to do.

Brian wanted to learn other kinds of activities.

He asked a magician if he would teach him. The magician agreed to teach him.

Brian visited every day for a month. He watched how each routine was done and practiced a lot. Brian learned how to perform different kinds of magic.

He selected tricks that he could do best. He put together a good act, showing his teacher. He made some pretty flowers come out of her ear and then made the flowers disappear. The magic act was a hit and was selected for the show.

Story 2: Living Underground: The Life of a Mole (TA)

The mole is a small furry animal that lives underground. It moves around in tunnels that it digs. Moles' bodies have changed over time in four ways because they live underground.

First, the mole has short, solid legs that are good for digging tunnels. This helps the mole dig tunnels so it can hunt for worms to eat. The mole also digs a home tunnel where it sleeps.

Second, good hearing is important so the mole can tell when other animals are in its tunnels. The mole's ears are tiny because larger ears would get in the way when digging.

Third, the mole's eyes are very small and they can "see" only light and dark. This is because moles live underground where it is dark, so it is not important for them to see.

Finally, because it is dark underground, the mole has a special way of figuring out where it is going. When it is going forward, the mole feels its way with its nose and the hairs on its front feet. When the mole is going backward, its tail tells it which way to go.